

apps for the device.

As before, the SDK is available on HTC's developer website and comes with distributable libraries and JavaDoc API documentation. The SDK contains two APIs—DualLens and DimensionPlus. While the former is exclusive to the HTC One (M8), the latter can run on other devices.

Other initiatives

Country head (India), Faisal Siddiqui, confirmed that the Taiwanese giant has been planning to host events for Indian developers soon, though he did not specify when exactly these would be scheduled.

The company already has developer initiatives in the United States. In addition, it is also a sponsor for the AnDevCon conference, which is the biggest Android developers' conference in the world. In 2014, the conference is scheduled from May 27 to May 30, in Boston.

No plans for an app store

In spite of all its open source efforts, HTC doesn't yet have an app store of its own. According to Siddiqui, the apps that developers come up with will currently be featured on the Google Play store only. The company currently doesn't have any plans to come up with an app store of its own. Siddiqui says that using Google Play is better, as it makes it easier for developers to create their apps and make them public.

Taking India seriously

The company reiterated its commitment to India on multiple occasions at the launch event in Delhi, but as the old saying goes, actions speak louder than words. HTC is known for its high priced devices, which has sometimes put off Indian consumers. The HTC One (M8), on the other hand, even though it is a flagship model, is priced at a strategic Rs 49,900. This places the device in the high-end segment, but at a lower price than the Apple iPhone 5S and Samsung's Galaxy S5. The pricing is an indicator of how serious HTC is about the Indian market.

At the same event, HTC launched its Desire 210 smartphone, which is a budget model aimed at a lower market segment. Interestingly, this was also the global launch for the device. A global launch is something that is not usually seen in India, considering the Indian market's uniqueness and price sensitivity.

The launch of the M8 and Desire 210 was also accompanied by the launch of the Desire 816 smartphone, which is a mid-range device priced in the Rs 24,000 bracket. So, the company launched three devices, one each in the budget, mid-range and high-end segments, further demonstrating that India is a market that HTC means to take seriously.

The flagship device, though, is the one being talked about the most, all over the world. The HTC M8 has a 90

"The Sense UI indeed offers a lot of scope to developers. The Blinkfeed, which is one of its primary components, can easily be a developer's dream. For the uninitiated, the Blinkfeed is a compilation of your entire social network, news and some other apps"

per cent metal body along with a 4 Ultrapixel dual camera and a 12.7-cm (5-inch) 1080x1920 pixel screen. The device runs the Android 4.4 KitKat operating system and is powered by the 2.5 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 801 quad core processor.

The new device has quite a legacy to live up to, and HTC seems to have kept up its pace of innovation. Its predecessor, the HTC One, took more than its share of awards and was recently ranked the best smartphone at the MWC 2014. The M8 has already been shortlisted to be among the best smartphones in the world, by multiple national and international sources. And with the new open source initiatives, it seems well on its way to proving people's predictions right. **END** 



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